LAB 2 · REDESIGNING A DIGITAL EXPERIENCE

Spotify: creating a playlist

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1. Selected application

I documented the desktop app of Spotify (Premium plan). The task is to create a new playlist and fill it with songs that fit together.

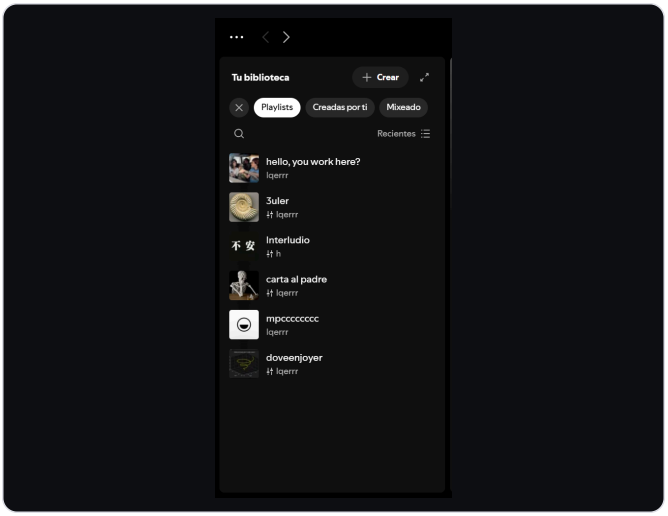
APP	FEATURE	TASK
Spotify (desktop, Premium)	**Create a playlist and add songs**	**Build a playlist with one style**

My screenshots are in Spanish; the captions use the English labels.

2. Current user flow

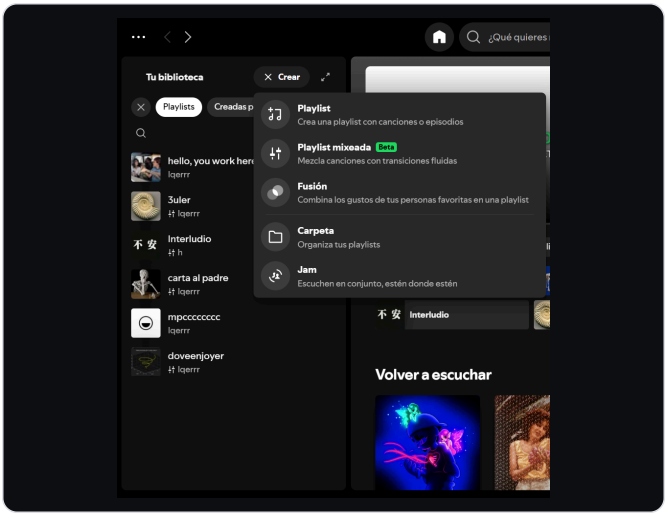
To get the first song into a new playlist I need four actions:

Your library → 1. Create → 2. Playlist → 3. Add → 4. ⊕ on a song



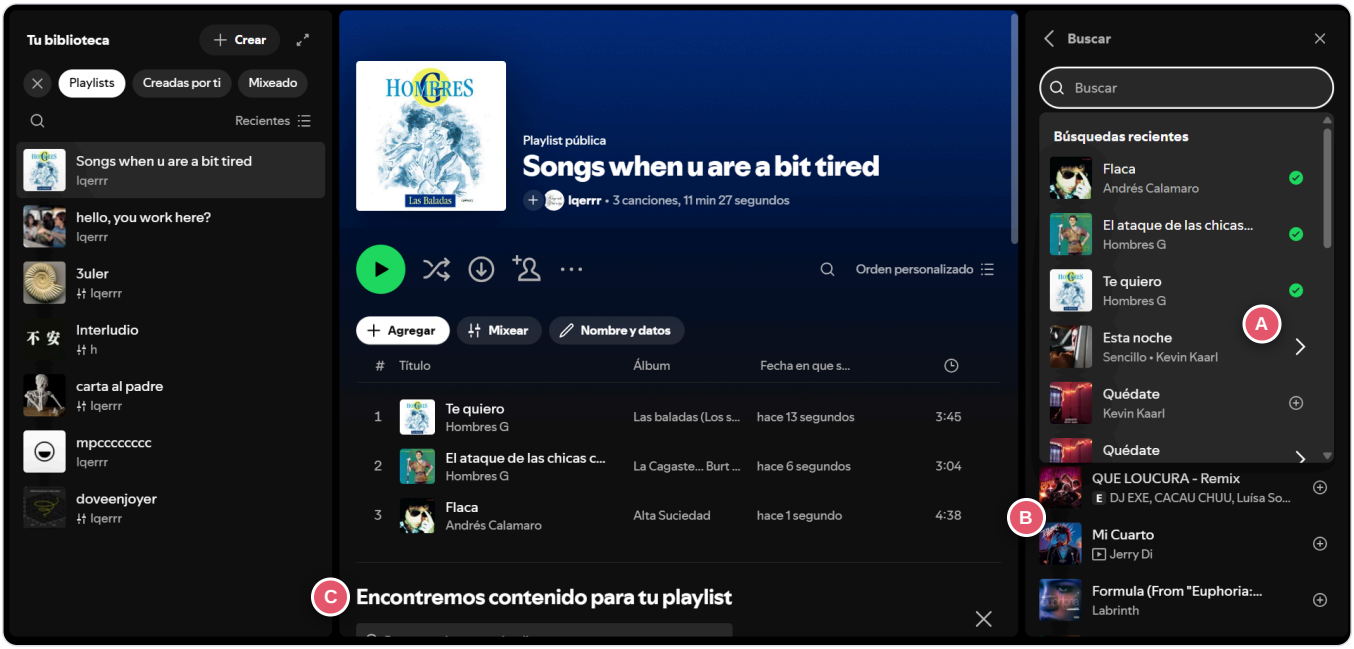
Step 1 · Press Create

In the Library panel, the "+ Create" button is at the top right.



Step 2 · Choose "Playlist"

A menu with five options opens. "Playlist" is the first one.



Steps 3 and 4 · Add songs. The new playlist opens and “Add” shows a Search panel on the right. Songs already added have a green ✓ and the rest have a ⊕. Below the recent searches there are suggested songs (B), and under the playlist a block called “Let’s find content for your playlist” (C).

3. UX analysis

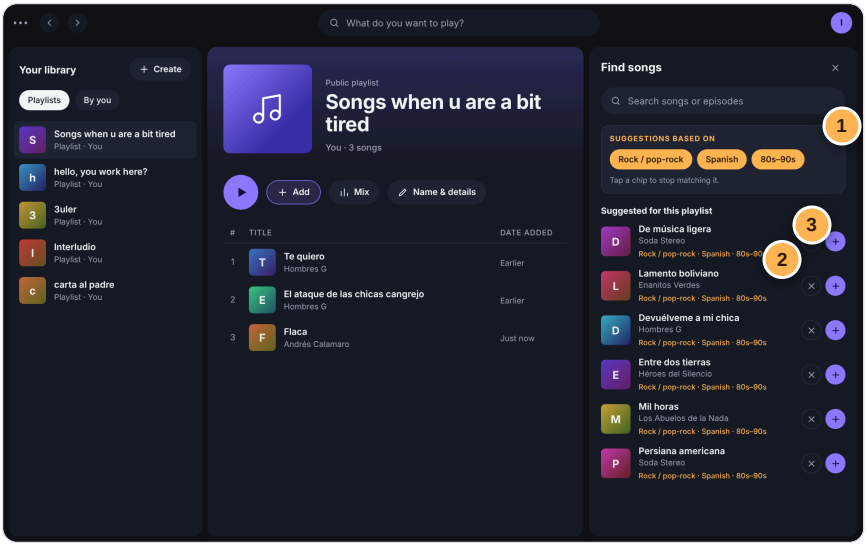
- **How many steps?** Four actions to add the first song, then one click per song.
- **Is the navigation clear?** Yes. Create → Playlist is simple and “Playlist” is the first option.
- **Is the feature easy to find?** Yes. Create is always visible in the Library panel.
- **Are the buttons easy to identify?** Mostly. In the Search panel one column mixes a ✓, a ⊕ and a › with no labels (A).
- **Is the information well organized?** Not completely. Recent searches and suggestions share one panel without a clear separation (B).
- **Confusing moments:** “Let’s find content for your playlist” (C) suggests songs chosen for my playlist, but my playlist is Spanish-language rock and the suggestions included an electronic remix, an urban track and a TV-series soundtrack. Nothing explains why, and I can’t remove them.

> Problem I chose to solve: the suggestions don’t match the style of my playlist, and I can’t understand or change them.

What I would change: keep Create → Playlist as it is and improve the suggestions, so they follow the playlist and the user can control them.

4. Design proposal

The panel shows **what the suggestions are based on** (the style, language and era of the songs already in the playlist) as chips the user can switch off. Each suggestion says what it matches, and a ✕ hides the ones the user doesn’t want.



Proposed screen with three songs in the playlist.

1. **Chips**
   Style, language and era of the playlist. Tap one to stop matching it.
2. **Reason line**
   Each suggestion says what it matches.
3. **× Hide**
   Removes a suggestion the user doesn't want, next to the ⊕.

Other changes

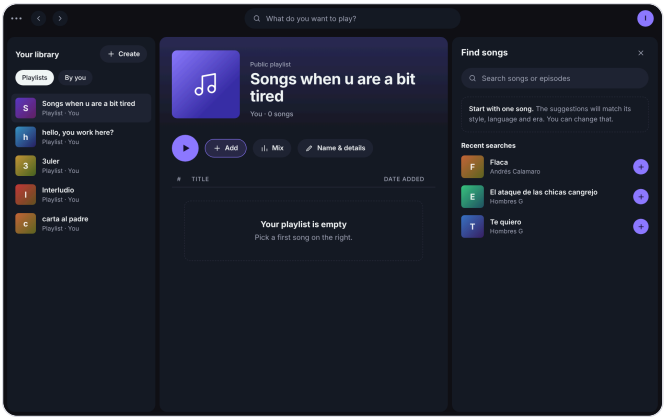
- **Steps:** the Find songs panel opens by default on a new playlist, so the first song takes 3 actions instead of 4.
- **Colors:** a dark base, violet for the main action (⊕) and amber for what the user can change (chips). Spotify's green is not used.
- **Typography and icons:** one typeface (Inter) in regular and bold, and one set of simple line icons.
- **Feedback:** a short message after hiding a song, with an Undo button.

5. Proposed user flow

The first two steps don't change. The rest works like this:

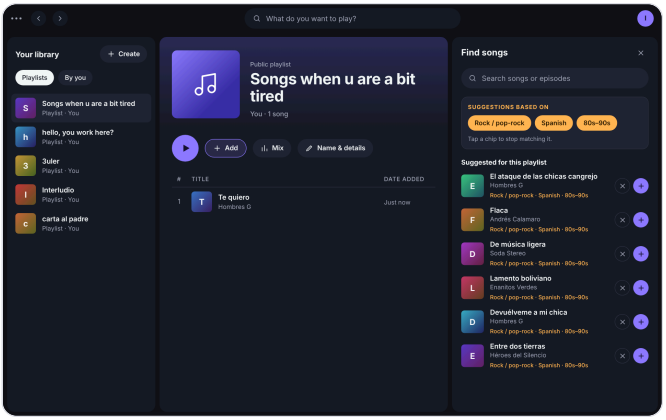
1. Create → 2. Playlist → 3. ⊕ first song → Suggestions match it → ⊕ add · × hide · chip

FRAME 1



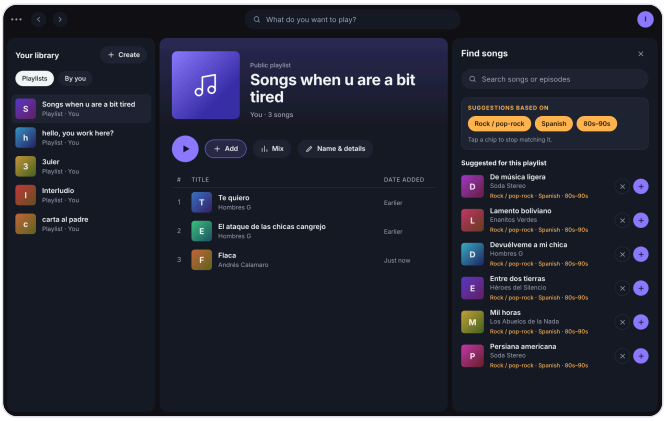
The new playlist is empty and the Find songs panel is already open.

FRAME 2



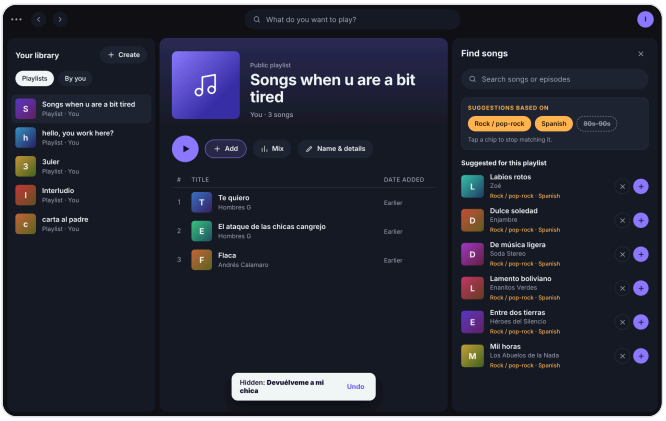
After the first song, the chips appear and the suggestions match them.

FRAME 3



With three songs, every suggestion is Spanish-language rock from the 80s–90s.

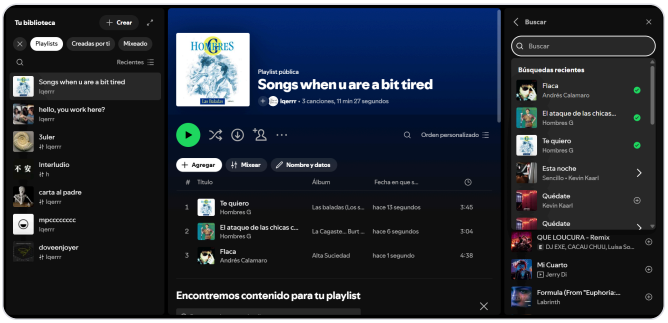
FRAME 4



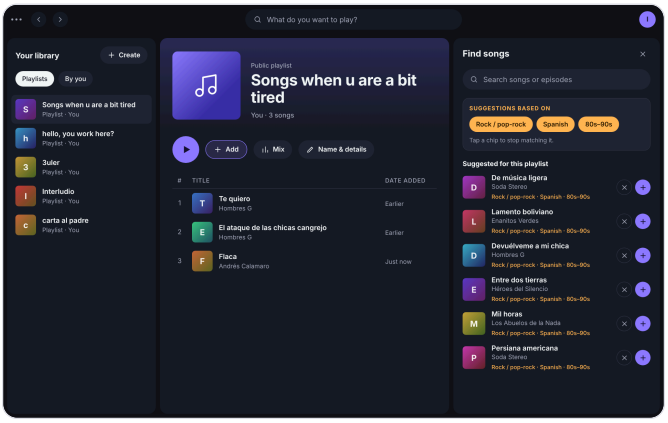
I switched off the “80s–90s” chip, so newer Spanish rock appears, and hid one song with ×. A message offers Undo.

6. Before and after

CURRENT



PROPOSED



MOMENT	CURRENT	PROPOSED
Actions to the first song	4	3 (the panel opens by default)
Why a song is suggested	Not explained	A reason line under each song
Control over suggestions	None, only ⊕	Chips to change them and × to hide
Feedback after an action	Only a ✓ on added songs	A message with Undo

7. Justification

- **UX (clarity and ease of use):** the problem I found, suggestions that seem random, is solved by showing what they are based on and letting the user change it. The steps that already worked stay the same.
- **UI and visual hierarchy:** the chips are boxed at the top because they control everything below. The ⊕ is the strongest button and the × is quieter, so it is available but not distracting.

- **Consistency:** all four screens use the same colors, typeface and icons. Violet always means “add” and amber always means “what the suggestions match”.
- **Creativity:** instead of only changing how the list looks, I changed what the panel does: it explains its suggestions and accepts the user’s corrections.
- **Less effort:** one fewer action to the first song, and one click to hide a song that doesn’t belong.

Note: the mockups use a small set of example songs. A real version would need Spotify’s own data to decide what each song matches.

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